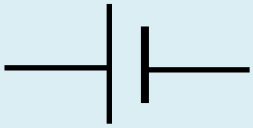
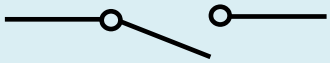
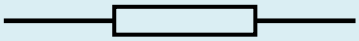
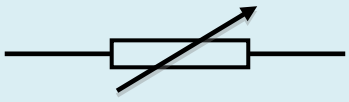
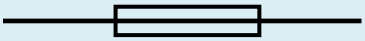
Teaching notes

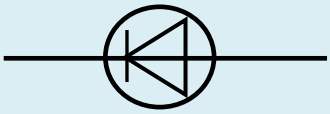
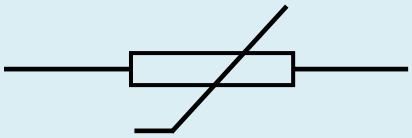
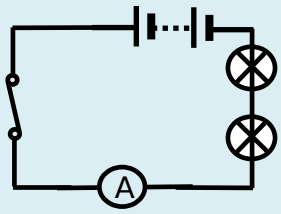
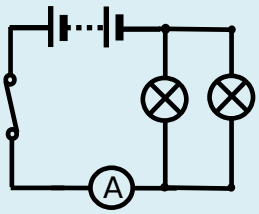
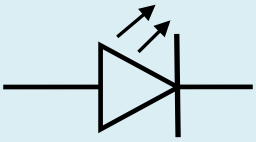
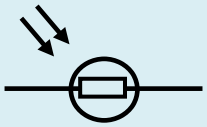
Taboo is a word guessing game. The objective is to have your team guess the keyword on top of a card. This must be accomplished without using the word itself or any of the additional 'taboo' (forbidden) words listed on the card.

1. Students work in teams
2. Each team needs a set of cards.
3. The cards need to be shuffled and placed face down.
4. An individual from the first team takes the card from the top of the pile, and then describes the symbol and keyword at the top of the card without using the words below. The rest of their team must guess which word is described. Participants are not allowed to say 'sounds like' or 'rhymes with' and no gestures or sounds. The rest of the team guess the keyword and/or draw the symbol.
5. Should the individual use one of the taboo words, a member of the opposing team may challenge and the individual must move on to the next word.
6. Each individual is allowed two minutes to describe as many words/symbols as possible to the players in their team before play passes to the next team.
7. For each word which is correctly guessed, the playing team receives one point.

This activity is designed to extend the students' vocabulary range by finding other ways to describe the keyword. It allows a review of scientific vocabulary in addition to reinforcing the students' memory of each scientific term and symbol.

In the lesson or homework prior to playing this game, the students could research the keywords and symbols.

cell 	**battery** 	**open switch** 
• voltage • battery • cell • current	• voltage • battery • cell • current • rechargeable	• switch • open • circuit • current • on
closed switch 	**bulb** 	**resistor** 
• switch • closed • circuit • current • off	• light • lamp • bulb • filament	• resistor • circuit • current
variable resistor 	**fuse** 	**voltmeter** 
• variable • resistor • current	• fuse • melt • current • amps • plugs	• voltmeter • voltage • potential difference • parallel

ammeter 	**diode** 	**thermistor** 
• ammeter • amps • series • current	• diode • direction • current • resistance	• thermistor • resistance • temperature • resistor
series circuit 	**parallel circuit** 	**light emitting diode (LED)** 
• series • circuit • current • lamp • battery • switch	• parallel • circuit • current • lamp • battery	• light • diode • LED • direction
light dependent resistor (LDR) 	**ohms** **Ω**	**volt** **V**
• light • dependent • resistor • resistance • LDR	• resistance • Ohm's law • current	• **potential difference** • **voltage** • **voltmeter**